

RECRUITING THE MERCS

The heroes were hired as the heads of security for a large-scale trade caravan moving through brigand-infested lands. The caravan suggested they seek out additional help to provide rank-and-file protection for such a long haul.

It just so happens that a local mercenary group known as the Band of the Falcon is looking for work... if their leader, Grit, can be convinced the profits are worth the danger.

You can use one of the following hooks for this encounter, replacing any of the named concepts with elements from your own campaign:

Hawking Falcons. A young boy wearing a training sword roams the street handing out flyers he clearly made himself. "The Band of the Falcon! Famous mercenaries! Ready to work! See Grit at the Old Alehouse!" he cries. It... can't really be that easy, can it?

Mercantile Mercenary. In the town market, a commotion has broken out. A woman with an eyepatch and a sword at her hip is shouting at a bored-looking merchant as they haggle over prices for "enough corn to feed thirty men-at-arms."

Punch Drunk. A mean-looking drunk, hurling insults, has been backed into a corner by a gang of brawlers. Before anyone can help, a woman with an eyepatch and a sword rounds the corner and beats them to a pulp. She berates the man for 'giving mercenaries a bad name' as she drags him away into the night.

Theophania "Grit" Griffin

Serious Mercenary Leader

The Band of the Falcon was once a renowned mercenary organization, but after its leader, "Old Bird" Griffin, was arrested and executed some 15 years ago. The band today is much smaller in size, and they're starting to become desperate. They'd offer their services to anyone with enough gold or even food if it weren't for Grit.

"Grit" Griffin, the Old Bird's granddaughter, has held together what's left of the Falcons through dedication and being very picky about what jobs they take. If she takes a job, it's because she believes the reward offered is more than worth the assumed risk.

Playing Grit

Grit is serious and focused on her task. She eschews small talk and euphemisms and always cuts straight to the matter at hand. She is honest and coolheaded, getting frustrated and threatening only when it comes to those who try to break a contract or to cheat her.

Her experiences as a mercenary give her a tendency to assume the worst and play her cards cautiously, but the Falcons' desperate need forces her to take risks she might otherwise not.

Encounter Credits

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Grit Griffin

Species: Human

Combat Stat Block: Human Blackguard (*Draw Steel: Monsters*)

Skills: Alertness, History, Interrogate, Intimidate, Lead, Read Person, Society, Strategy

Languages: Vaslorian (Native), Kalliak, Khoursirian

Interest: 3

Patience: 3

Impression: 3

Motivations

Protection: The Falcons are Grit's family, and as their leader she is responsible for their lives and their livelihoods. Whatever she does, she does for the betterment of the Band of the Falcon.

Legacy: Under the Old Bird, the Band of the Falcon was one of the most famous, well-regarded gangs of sellswords around. Grit was raised on stories of their deeds and of her grandfather's exceptional abilities. Her greatest dream is to restore the Falcons' position and leave her own mark on history.

Pitfalls

Peace: Grit sells her sword for money. It's more than just a job, it's a career. A calling. If she wanted a peaceful, boring life she could have been a bookkeeper like her father. While she works to keep the Falcons alive, they are mercenaries, and peace is bad for business.

Revelry: Grit has no time for fun or frolic; she has supplies to source and people to kill. Further, she finds jokes, banter, flattery, and other such frivolity to be a waste of her precious time and an insult to her as a businesswoman.

Negotiation with Grit Griffin can have the following outcomes:

- **Interest 5:** In addition to her agreeing to do the job, Grit's high opinion of you spreads to the rest of the local mercenaries. You are always welcome in the Falcon's Camp.
- **Interest 4:** Grit agrees to do the job, offering a rare smile and a firm handshake.
- **Interest 3:** Grit would take the job, but a rival mercenary gang is pressuring the grain merchant she buys from to cut ties. The heroes will have to deal with them before the Falcons sign on.
- **Interest 2:** Grit doesn't think this sort of job is really a good fit for the Falcons, but she does know a slightly disreputable gang of ex-bandits that might be interested.
- **Interest 1:** Grit thanks the heroes for the offer but must decline. Nothing personal, it's just business.
- **Interest 0:** Not only does Grit refuse to deal with the heroes anymore, but she will badmouth them to everyone she knows.

If the heroes gain the services of the Band of the Falcon, they earn 1 Victory.

Rewards

A hero can earn the following rewards:

Title: Friend of the Falcons

Prerequisites: End the negotiation with Interest 0.

Effect: When interacting with mercenaries, treat your Renown as 1 higher.

Title: Foe of the Falcons

Prerequisites: End the negotiation with Interest 0.

Effect: When interacting with mercenaries, treat your Renown as 1 lower.